MIRGASIM ART™

FINE ART ATELIER • BAKU & ABSHERON

OFFICIAL GALLERY SUBMISSION

Curatorial Commission Proposal & Artist Dossier

Absheron Tectonics: Primordial Matter & Geological Strata

COMMISSIONING BODY	REPRESENTING ARTIST	DOSSIER DATE	DOCUMENT STATUS
Gazelli Art House (London / Baku)	Mirgasim (Mirgasim Art Studio)	October 2026	Final Master Proposal

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EXECUTIVE CURATORIAL STATEMENT

"True regional modernism does not decorate with heritage; it builds from the literal mineral dust, salt crust, and petroleum strata of the homeland."

Responding directly to the curatorial brief for **Gazelli Art House**, this body of work represents a radical evolution of Azerbaijani contemporary fine art. Grounded in the modernist lineage of the **Absheron School**—reverberating with the monumental expressionism of Javad Mirjavadov, the luminous atmospheric landscapes of Sattar Bahlulzade, and the uncompromising graphic vigor of Rasim Babayev—these five works abandon decorative tourist clichés in favor of raw geological matter.

Rigorous Curatorial Constraints Adhered To:

- **Authentic Raw Substances**: Every canvas incorporates direct geological extractions: crystallized pink-and-white Masazir lake salt, dried Lokbatan mud-volcano craquelure clay, raw Binagadi bitumen, Turkan coquina limestone, and Caspian coastal shell-sand.
- **Caspian Endemic Biodiversity**: Form and texture are informed exclusively by endemic wildlife: the prehistoric armored Caspian tadpole goby (*Benthophilus*), Caspian marine shad (*Alosa braschnikowi*), ancient Didacna bivalve fossils, and the primordial Caspian lamprey (*Caspiomyzon wagneri*).
- **Strictly Carpet-Free Fine Art Discipline**: By curatorial mandate, all repetitive carpet patterns, rug motifs, and textile fringes have been completely eliminated, ensuring the mineral substances, petroglyphs, and architectural masonry speak with unfiltered fine art purity.
- **Strategic 3:2 Hybrid Straddle**: Balancing serene, meditative mineral-infused earth-art (Works 1, 2, and 4) with dynamic industrial-petroleum and mythic archaeological drama (Works 3 and 5).

Collection Master Overview

NO.	ARTWORK TITLE	FORMAT / SIZE	PRIMARY MATERIAL	ENDEMIC FOCUS
01	*Strata of Masazir: Crystalline Salt Landscape*	185 × 120 cm (Landscape)	Masazir Pink Lake Salt, Limestone	Lacustrine Evaporite Strata
02	*The Shebeke Reliquary: Fossil Didacna*	150 × 200 cm (Vertical)	Coquina, Caspian Sand, Shells	Caspian Cockle (*Didacna* spp.)
03	*The Binagadi Derrick: Hydrocarbon Strata*	120 × 200 cm (Vertical)	Binagadi Bitumen, Pyrite Ore	Caspian Marine Shad (*Alosa*)
04	*[Work in Progress / Forthcoming]*	180 × 180 cm (Square 1:1)	Mud-Volcano Clay, Verdigris Glazes	Armored Caspian Goby (*Benthophilus*)
05	*The Gobustan Solar Oracle: Lamprey*	100 × 150 cm (Portrait)	Beach Sand, Lake Salt, Plaster	Caspian Lamprey (*Caspiomyzon*)

PLATE 01 • PURE MINERAL ABSTRACTION

Strata of Masazir: Crystalline Salt Landscape

Masazır Layları: Çəhrayı Duz Abstraksiyası



DIMENSIONS	**185 × 120 cm** (Horizontal Fine Art Canvas, Specification from Brief)
MEDIUM / TECHNIQUES	Genuine Masazir Pink Salt Encrustations, Porous Absheron Limestone Plaster, Heavy Palette-Knife Sculptural Impasto, Deep Incised Sgraffito Fissures
MATERIAL PROVENANCE	Lake Masazir Saline Evaporites (Masazır gölü, Absheron) & Badamdar Limestone Dust
CURATORIAL CONCEPT	A tranquil, meditative horizontal abstract landscape capturing the primordial mineral strata of Lake Masazir. Soft undulating terraces of rose-quartz, blush pink, oyster cream, and warm alabaster white are built with thick palette-knife impasto. Embedded in high relief are sparkling crystalline salt clusters, scored with razor-thin sgraffito fissures. Completely non-figurative and free of portraits, figures, seals, or textiles.

ALTERNATIVE STUDY VARIATIONS (STUDIO ITERATIONS)



Study B: *Stepped Crystalline Salt Terraces*



Study C: *Luminescent Sunrise over Misty Saline Shoreline*

PLATE 02 • ARCHITECTURAL MASONRY & FOSSIL STRATA

The Shebeke Reliquary: Fossil Didacna in Absheron Stone

Şəbəkə Qalığı: Qədim Didakna və Daş Pəncərə



DIMENSIONS	**150 × 200 cm** (Vertical Monumental Canvas, Specification from Brief)
MEDIUM / TECHNIQUES	Porous Coquina Stone Relief, Absheron Beach Sand Plaster, Fossilized Caspian *Didacna* Shells in High Sculptural Relief, Turquoise & Lapis Lazuli Glazes
ENDEMIC ORGANISM	Caspian Cockle (*Didacna trigonoides* / *Didacna pyramidata*)
CURATORIAL CONCEPT	Honoring Absheron's thousand-year stone-carving heritage (*daş yonma*), a heavy coquina wall reveals an intricate geometric stone Shebeke window lattice. Behind the carved aperture glows deep Caspian turquoise and lapis lazuli light. Protruding from the masonry are radiant *Didacna* cockles, while an elongated, sculpted hand touches the stone frame, symbolizing human craftsmanship rooted in deep geological time.

PLATE 03 • INDUSTRIAL-GEOLOGICAL ABSTRACTION

The Binagadi Derrick: Hydrocarbon Strata & Pyrite Shad

Binaqədi Buruğu: Qara Qızıl və Pirit Şad



DIMENSIONS	**120 × 200 cm** (Vertical Panoramic Canvas, Specification from Brief)
MEDIUM / TECHNIQUES	Raw Unrefined Binagadi Bitumen, Pyrite Sulfide Aggregates, Chalky Limestone Contrast Sgraffito, Oil & Industrial Asphaltite Knife Impasto
ENDEMIC WILDLIFE	Caspian Marine Shad / Brazhnikov's Shad (*Alosa braschnikowi*)
CURATORIAL CONCEPT	Confronting Baku's iconic heritage as the cradle of the world petroleum industry, minimal structural scaffolding beams inspired by historic wooden oil derricks slice across visceral slabs of pitch-black Binagadi bitumen. Leaping through the dark matrix is an armored Caspian marine shad adorned with metallic golden pyrite ore, set above the eternal subterranean gas flame (*Yanar Dağ / Ateshgah*).

PLATE 04 • WORK IN PROGRESS / RESERVED

[Work 04: Atelier Development in Progress]

Lökbatan Nəfəsi: Yeni Seriya Üzərində İş Gedir



STATUS	**Reserved for Forthcoming Atelier Review** (Work in Progress)
TARGET DIMENSIONS	**180 × 180 cm** (Square Format 1:1, Specification from Brief)
PROPOSED MEDIUM	Subterranean Lokbatan Mud-Volcano Clay, Luminous Caspian Greenish-Blue Mineral Glazes (Celadon, Seafoam, Verdigris), Natural Craquelure Fissures & Pyrite Vein Infiltration
PROPOSED ENDEMIC FAUNA	Armored Caspian Tadpole Goby (*Benthophilus* spp.)
CURATORIAL NOTE	Work #4 is currently being redesigned from scratch in the atelier to replace earlier dark earthy tones with radiant, pleasing Caspian greenish-blue palettes and a strict 1:1 square composition. The final artwork plate and alternative studies will be integrated upon completion of the new generation series.

PLATE 05 • MYTHOLOGICAL ARCHAEOLOGICAL TOTEM

The Gobustan Solar Oracle: Ouroboros Lamprey

Qobustan Günəşi: İlanbalığı və Qədim Qaya Təsvirləri



DIMENSIONS	**100 × 150 cm** (Vertical Portrait Canvas, Specification from Brief)
MEDIUM / TECHNIQUES	Absheron Coastal Beach Sand Mandala, Masazir Salt Encrustations, Incised Gobustan Petroglyphic Sgraffito, Oil & Bone Plaster on Linen
ENDEMIC WILDLIFE	Caspian Lamprey (*Caspiomyzon wagneri*)
CURATORIAL CONCEPT	A transcendental contemporary altar piece uniting prehistoric rock art with ecological mystery. The ancient Caspian lamprey coils into an Ouroboros circle of eternity around a concentric sand-and-salt solar mandala. Incised directly into the bone-plaster and limestone ground are Gobustan petroglyphs (reed boats, hunters, and sacred solar bulls), immortalizing Absheron's ancient rock art heritage within deep cosmological time.

STUDIO ARCHIVAL CHEMISTRY & PRODUCTION STANDARDS

To ensure every commissioned artwork meets the archival and conservation standards of international museums and tier-one private collections, **Mirgasim Art Studio** executes all works under strict chemical binding and material stability protocols:

SUBSTANCE / MATERIAL	GEOLOGICAL SOURCING ORIGIN	STUDIO CONSERVATION & ARCHIVAL PROTOCOL
Masazir Lake Salt	Lake Masazir, Absheron	Dehydrated at 60°C to eliminate deliquescence risk; embedded in high-grade acrylic gloss gel and sealed with 2 coats of UV mineral fixative varnish.
Lokbatan Volcanic Clay	Lokbatan Mud Volcano, Absheron	Centrifuged and blended with archival acrylic co-polymer emulsion to regulate craquelure tensile strength and prevent structural flaking.
Binagadi Bitumen	Binagadi Outcrops, Absheron	Pure asphaltite dissolved in odorless archival spirits and bound in heavy-body gloss polymer, ensuring rich black depth without softening.
Turkan Coquina & Shells	Turkan & Mardakan Coastal Quarries	Sterilized in dilute hydrogen peroxide, dry-sawn into relief plates, and anchored into structural limestone gesso with fiberglass reinforcing mesh.
Absheron Beach Sand	Pirshaghi & Bilgah Coastal Waterline	Triple-rinsed in freshwater to eliminate sodium chloride traces; oven-baked and sifted for controlled tactile grain gradation.

Milestone Production Timelines

STANDARD PRODUCTION TRACK

4 Months (16 Weeks)

Allows full natural craquelure curing, multi-layer oil/bitumen oxidation, and complete studio condition reporting.

ACCELERATED COMMISSION TRACK

2 Months (8 Weeks)

Utilizes parallel studio atelier workflows and controlled thermal drying protocols for expedited institutional handover.

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